

2.3 percent in 48 days

Web traffic coming from Windows 8 based systems now constitutes 2.3 percent of the total 48 days after its release

**YouTube native player**

Native player API of YouTube for Android was finally launched by YouTube. This will enable in-app video playback on Android

The latest from the web, straight to print

Redesigns, future trends and a peek at technology standards that will enable these transformations

A story of redesigns

Over the past month or so we've seen a lot of redesigns on the web. And we're not just talking about small feature rollouts by the biggies like Facebook and Twitter. We're talking about websites that are likely to permanent fixtures on your bookmark favourites, completely transforming themselves with the current times. Sites like Mashable, Pandodaily, Readwriteweb, The Next Web, Macworld now look nothing like they used to. So what do these re-designs entail? The Pinterest design philosophy seems to be catching on quite a bit. Most of these websites now look like popular news reader apps such as Pulse, FlipBoard - a mosaic of boxy stories with large pictures.

The web, it seems, is increasingly going towards a magazine style layout. These columns often have independent scroll capabilities in some cases and much of this layout is obviously catering to newer devices accessing the web; you got it - tablets in portrait mode. It's all touch, zoom, and swipe friendly.

What to look forward to on the web in 2013?

The web is all about access and ease of use. Keeping this in mind these are the top four things that you can look forward to in the coming year.

Responsive web design: With the multitude of portable devices available in the market,

responsive wordpress themes already and 2013 will see a lot more of this.

Better Typography: As the web tries to mimic magazine layouts, selection of fonts will be of great importance.

Floating menus: There's no escaping vertical scrolling especially when it comes to smaller screens. To make life easier popular web design will incorporate floating menus so that you needn't go all the way to the top to navigate elsewhere.

Two-way scrolling: While vertical scrolling is here to stay, we'll see a lot of horizontal scrolling for some sections of a web page. For e.g. between text there may be an image gallery which you'll be able to swipe and look through by scrolling horizontally.

More sharing: Who doesn't like to share (read:show off) and the web in 2013 will be geared towards more of it.

And what will enable the seamless deployment of these design philosophies in the coming year? Our next story is encouraging news on this front. Read on...



Responsive web design can handle different screen sizes

Panels - a throwback to the old web - are back in style. Most have three panels dividing up the content, but it would be unfair to call them panels because they don't have those ugly scroll bars from yesteryears, they're more like columns; magazine columns.

Websites are now increasingly adapting themselves to different screen sizes. To see it in action visit www.polygon.com and re-size the window randomly. Watch as the website intelligently adapts its layout to match the changing window size. There are many

W3C Completes HTML5 Draft

A while back the W3C decided to maintain its own version of HTML5 with the goal of producing a stable definition that can be implemented in a compatible manner.

The current development model for HTML is to continue

making improvements based on feedback, but that makes it difficult to have a stable and reliable platform. Different browsers can claim to support HTML5, but target is continually moving, and each browser supports a different range of features, none support all. Part of this problem can be solved by techniques such as feature detection, and progressive enhancement, but it is still nice to have a baseline that can be expected.

That seems like exactly what the W3C is doing. They have taken HTML features that have become de facto standards, pulled them in under the banner of HTML5, and published that as a stable definition. With a stable definition for HTML5, it is possible to say definitively that a browser supports HTML5.

What the W3C has done now is to publish the "complete definition" of HTML5 and Canvas 2D, which includes a wide number of features already in use. W3C will now focus on interoperability of these features across browser and on testing, a stage it calls "Candidate Recommendation". What comes at the end is a W3C Recommendation, which is their equivalent of a standard.

The W3C has also announced the next iteration of web standards, with the release of the first draft of HTML5.1 and Canvas 2D, Level 2. The W3C community has set sights on features such as "responsive images, and adaptive streaming." (More: <http://dvwx.in/ZPCp6L>)